

Four Government Schemes *Your Family Should Have*

₹9 lakh of cover for under ₹500 a year. Most of us never switch them on.

This list does a round on Instagram every few months and I kept seeing the same version of it. Most of the numbers in it are right. Four of them are out of date, and one of those four means the scheme is now closed to most salaried people. So I sat with the actual government rule books and rewrote the whole thing. Four schemes, what they really pay, what the fine print says, and the exact steps to switch them on. The four corrections are on the next page.

- 1 PMSBY.** ₹2 lakh if you die or are permanently disabled in an accident. Costs ₹20 for the year.
- 2 PMJJBY.** ₹2 lakh to your nominee if you die of any cause. Costs ₹436 for the year.
- 3 PM-JAY.** ₹5 lakh of cashless hospital treatment a year. Free, if your family qualifies. Every citizen above 70 now qualifies.
- 4 APY.** A guaranteed ₹1,000 to ₹5,000 a month after 60. There is now a rule that stops most salaried people from joining.

ACCIDENT COVER

₹20 / yr

LIFE COVER

₹436 / yr

HEALTH COVER

Free

PENSION AFTER 60

₹1k to ₹5k

What ₹456 a year actually *buys you*

Two are pure insurance and cost less than one pizza for a whole year. One is free. One has a catch.

SCHEME	WHAT IT PAYS	YOUR COST	WHO CAN JOIN
PMSBY	₹2 lakh, accidental death or total disability	₹20/yr	Age 18 to 70
PMJJBY	₹2 lakh on death from any cause	₹436/yr	Age 18 to 50
PM-JAY	₹5 lakh cashless hospital cover per family per year	Free	SECC-listed families, plus everyone 70+
APY	₹1,000 to ₹5,000 a month for life after 60	₹42 to ₹1,454/mo	Age 18 to 40, non-taxpayers only
The two insurance ones together	Up to ₹4 lakh if the death is accidental	₹456/yr	Ten minutes in your bank app

Premiums as revised on 1 June 2022 and unchanged as of September 2026. Source: Department of Financial Services, jansuraksha.gov.in.

1 Four things the viral version of this list gets wrong

I checked every number against the government rule books. The premiums and the pension chart were correct. These four were not.

CORRECTION 1 · APY

If you pay income tax, you cannot join Atal Pension Yojana at all.

Changed on 1 October 2022. Any citizen who is, or has been, an income tax payer is barred from joining. Those who joined earlier keep their accounts.

CORRECTION 2 · PMJJBY

There is a 30 day waiting period on the life cover.

Die of anything other than an accident within 30 days of enrolling and the ₹2 lakh is not paid. Accidental death is covered from day one.

CORRECTION 3 · PM-JAY

It is no longer only for SECC 2011 families.

Since 29 October 2024, every citizen aged 70 and above gets ₹5 lakh of cover regardless of income, through the Ayushman Vay Vandana card. Your parents may qualify even if the household was never listed.

CORRECTION 4 · APY TAX BENEFIT

The 80CCD(1B) deduction is close to useless here.

Taxpayers cannot join, and the deduction lives only in the old tax regime, which is no longer the default.

PMSBY, the cheapest insurance *in India*

Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana. ₹2 lakh of accident cover for ₹20 a year. That is one rupee and sixty seven paise a month.

THE DETAILS

Pays: ₹2 lakh on accidental death or total permanent disability. ₹1 lakh for partial permanent disability, such as losing sight in one eye or the use of one limb.

Premium: ₹20 a year, auto-debited from your savings account by 31 May each year.

Cover year: 1 June to 31 May.

Who: Anyone aged 18 to 70 with a savings bank or post office account.

Renewal: Automatic. You enrol once and it keeps running.

Where: jansuraksha.gov.in

HOW TO SWITCH IT ON

1. Open your bank app or net banking.
2. Search for PMSBY, or look under Insurance and Government Schemes.
3. Pick the account, give e-consent, submit. It takes about two minutes.
4. No branch visit and no medical test. If your bank app does not have it, carry your Aadhaar and passbook to the branch and ask for the PMSBY consent form.
5. Save the SMS confirmation. Your family will need to know this exists.

THE PART THAT ACTUALLY MATTERS

One person, one account. And the balance has to be there in May.

You can hold PMSBY through only one bank account. If the ₹20 auto-debit fails because the account is empty or dormant, the cover lapses quietly and nobody calls to tell you. Check once a year that it went through. Also make sure the nominee name in that account is the person you actually want the money to reach.

WORTH KNOWING

58.09 crore people have enrolled. ₹3,667 crore has been paid out on 1.84 lakh claims.

Those are the government's own numbers as of 29 April 2026. This is a real scheme that pays real claims, not a paper announcement.

DO NOT CONFUSE THIS

₹2 lakh is not a term plan. It is a top-up on top of one.

₹2 lakh will not run a household. If anyone depends on your income, you still need a proper term plan of ten to fifteen times your annual income. Treat PMSBY as the free-ish extra layer, never as the plan.

PMJJBY, life cover for ₹36 a month

Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana. ₹2 lakh to your nominee if you die, from any cause, not only an accident.

THE DETAILS

Pays: ₹2 lakh to the nominee on death from any cause. Illness, accident, natural causes, all included.

Premium: ₹436 a year, auto-debited by 31 May. Join mid-year and you pay pro-rata: ₹342, ₹228 or ₹114 depending on the quarter.

Who: Age 18 to 50 with a savings bank or post office account. NRIs with an Indian account can join.

Cover runs till: Age 55, as long as you keep paying. You must join before you turn 50.

Waiting period: 30 days for non-accidental death.

Where: jansuraksha.gov.in

HOW TO SWITCH IT ON

1. Log in to your bank app or net banking.
2. Search PMJJBY or Jeevan Jyoti Bima.
3. Give e-consent for the auto-debit and submit. No medical test.
4. At the branch, ask for the PMJJBY consent-cum-declaration form.
5. Check the nominee name before you submit. This is the one field people get wrong.

THE 30 DAY RULE

Enrol today, not the week you feel unwell.

Death from any cause other than an accident is not covered for the first 30 days after you enrol. Accidental death is covered from day one. There is no medical test to join, so the waiting period is how the scheme protects itself. Enrol while you are fine and forget about it.

DO BOTH TOGETHER

₹20 plus ₹436 is ₹456 a year. In an accidental death, both pay, so the family gets ₹4 lakh.

In a non-accidental death only PMJJBY pays, so ₹2 lakh. Either way it is the cheapest cover your family will ever have. Both are enrolled from the same screen in most bank apps, so do them in one sitting.

FOR YOUR PARENTS AND YOUR HOUSE HELP

The 18 to 50 window closes on a fixed birthday.

If someone in your house is 49, this is the last year they can ever join. That is worth a phone call today. The same goes for domestic staff and drivers, most of whom have a Jan Dhan account and have never heard of either scheme. ₹456 a year is a small thing to gift someone.

Ayushman Bharat, ₹5 lakh of *free treatment*

PM Jan Arogya Yojana. Cashless hospital treatment up to ₹5 lakh per family per year, fully funded by the Centre and the states. You pay nothing at all.

THE DETAILS

Pays: Up to ₹5 lakh per family per year, cashless. Covers hospitalisation, surgery, ICU, medicines, diagnostics, and up to 15 days of post-hospitalisation care.

Premium: Nothing. It is funded 60:40 by the Centre and the states, 90:10 in the north-eastern and Himalayan states.

Who qualifies: Families listed in the SECC 2011 deprivation criteria, plus every citizen aged 70 and above regardless of income, plus ASHA and Anganwadi workers.

Where it works: 31,466 empanelled hospitals, of which 14,194 are private. It is portable across states.

You need: An Ayushman card, sometimes called the golden card.

Where: pmjay.gov.in and beneficiary.nha.gov.in

HOW TO CHECK AND APPLY

1. Go to pmjay.gov.in and click "Am I Eligible", or open the Ayushman app.
2. Enter the mobile number linked to your Aadhaar and verify the OTP.
3. Search by ration card, Aadhaar or family ID. The result shows on screen.
4. If eligible, complete e-KYC on the app or at a Common Service Centre and download the card.
5. For parents above 70, apply for the Vay Vandana card even if the family was never on the old list.
6. There is now a WhatsApp helpline, Ayushman Sarathi, on +91 72908 23838.

CHECK THIS ONE FOR YOUR PARENTS

Every Indian above 70 is covered now, whatever the family earns.

This came in on 29 October 2024 and a lot of people still do not know. A senior citizen in a family that already has a PM-JAY card gets their own top-up of ₹5 lakh so they are not competing with the rest of the family for the same limit. If your parents are above 70, this is the single most valuable thing in this guide and it costs nothing.

THE HONEST LIMITS

It only works inside an empanelled hospital, and only for listed packages.

Walk into a non-empanelled hospital and you pay in full. Treatment has to be admitted under the scheme's package list, and OPD consultations are not covered. Some private hospitals have pulled out over delayed payments, so check the hospital list on the app before an emergency, not during one. If you have a salaried job with health insurance, keep it. This is a floor, not a replacement.

Atal Pension Yojana, and *who it is really for*

A guaranteed monthly pension of ₹1,000 to ₹5,000 from age 60, for life. The guarantee is backed by the Government of India, which is the whole point of it.

READ THIS BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE

If you are an income tax payer, you cannot join. This has been the rule since 1 October 2022.

The notification says any citizen who is, or has been, an income tax payer is not eligible to join APY. If you file returns on a salary, skip to the next page and put that money in NPS or an index fund instead. If you joined before October 2022, your account continues normally. This scheme is aimed at people outside the tax net, which includes a lot of parents, domestic staff, drivers, small shop owners and gig workers you know.

THE DETAILS

Pays: A fixed ₹1,000, ₹2,000, ₹3,000, ₹4,000 or ₹5,000 a month from age 60, for life.

Who: Indian citizens aged 18 to 40, with an Aadhaar-linked savings account, who are not income tax payers.

After death: The spouse receives the same pension for life. After the spouse, the nominee gets the full accumulated corpus back.

Contribution: ₹42 a month at age 18 for the ₹1,000 slab, up to ₹1,454 a month at age 40 for the ₹5,000 slab.

Deadline: You must join before you turn 40. Every year you wait costs you more per month for the same pension.

Where: Your bank branch, your bank app, or enps.nsdl.com

HOW TO JOIN

1. Most banks now have APY inside the app under Investments or Government Schemes.
2. Or take Aadhaar and your savings account details to the branch and ask for the APY registration form.
3. Choose the pension slab. You can change it once a financial year.
4. Set the auto-debit. It can be monthly, quarterly or half-yearly.
5. Keep the balance topped up. A failed debit attracts a small penalty and long gaps can freeze the account.

THE NUMBER THAT DECIDES IT

Same ₹5,000 pension. ₹210 a month if you start at 18, ₹1,454 if you start at 40.

Seven times the cost for the same result, purely because of when you started. The full chart is on the next page. If there is someone in your family who is eligible and under 25, this is the one page to show them.

What you pay each month, *by joining age*

These are the official contribution amounts. Find your age on the left, find the pension you want on the top, and that is your monthly debit until you turn 60.

AGE WHEN JOINING	FOR ₹1,000/MO	FOR ₹2,000/MO	FOR ₹3,000/MO	FOR ₹5,000/MO	YEARS YOU PAY
18	₹42	₹84	₹126	₹210	42
20	₹50	₹100	₹150	₹248	40
25	₹76	₹151	₹226	₹376	35
30	₹116	₹231	₹347	₹577	30
35	₹181	₹362	₹543	₹902	25
40	₹291	₹582	₹873	₹1,454	20

Official APY contribution chart, PFRDA. The ₹4,000 slab sits between the ₹3,000 and ₹5,000 columns and is left out here for space. Verified September 2026.

2 What the nominee gets back

People assume the money disappears once the pension starts. It does not. On the death of both the subscriber and the spouse, the nominee receives the whole accumulated corpus as a lump sum.

MONTHLY PENSION CHOSEN	CORPUS RETURNED TO THE NOMINEE	WHO RECEIVES THE PENSION FIRST
₹1,000	₹1.70 lakh	Subscriber, then spouse for life
₹2,000	₹3.40 lakh	Subscriber, then spouse for life
₹3,000	₹5.10 lakh	Subscriber, then spouse for life
₹4,000	₹6.80 lakh	Subscriber, then spouse for life
₹5,000	₹8.50 lakh	Subscriber, then spouse for life

Indicative corpus as published by PFRDA. The pension itself is guaranteed by the Government of India.

KEEP THIS IN PERSPECTIVE

₹5,000 a month in 2026 money will not be ₹5,000 in purchasing power in 2060.

The pension amount is fixed and does not rise with inflation. At 6 percent inflation over 35 years, ₹5,000 buys roughly what ₹650 buys today. APY is a guaranteed floor under old age for people with no other pension. For anyone who can invest on top, it should sit alongside NPS or an equity SIP, not replace them.

The whole thing on *one page*

Print this, or screenshot it. Everything you need to decide what applies to you and what applies to your parents.

SCHEME	TYPE	WHAT IT PAYS	COST	AGE	WHERE TO APPLY
PMSBY	Accident insurance	₹2 lakh on accidental death or total disability, ₹1 lakh partial	₹20/yr	18 to 70	Bank app or branch
PMJJBY	Life insurance	₹2 lakh on death from any cause, after a 30 day wait	₹436/yr	18 to 50, cover till 55	Bank app or branch
PM-JAY	Health insurance	₹5 lakh cashless hospital cover per family per year	Free	SECC families, and all 70+	pmjay.gov.in, app or CSC
APY	Pension	₹1,000 to ₹5,000 a month for life after 60	₹42 to ₹1,454/mo	18 to 40, non-taxpayers	Bank branch or enps.nsdl.com
The three covers together	What most people should do	₹9 lakh of protection across accident, life and hospital	₹456/yr	Varies	About ten minutes

The ₹9 lakh figure adds three separate covers for three separate events. They do not all pay out together. An accidental death pays ₹4 lakh across PMSBY and PMJJBY, and PM-JAY only pays hospitals.

3 So who should do what

IF YOU ARE SALARIED AND PAY TAX

Take PMSBY and PMJJBY. Skip APY, it is closed to you. Check PM-JAY for your parents.

₹456 a year on top of your employer cover and your term plan. There is no reason not to.

IF YOU ARE SELF-EMPLOYED OR OUTSIDE THE TAX NET

All four apply, and APY is the one to start early.

A gig worker at 22 paying ₹50 a month locks in ₹1,000 a month for life. There is no equivalent guarantee available anywhere else at that price.

IF YOU ARE DOING THIS FOR YOUR PARENTS

PM-JAY if either of them is 70 or above. PMSBY if they are under 70.

PMJJBY closes at 50, so for most parents that ship has sailed. The Vay Vandana card is the one to chase.

Twenty minutes, *start to finish*

Open your bank app while you read this. Everything below can be done today from your phone.

- ☐ Open your bank app, search PMSBY, enrol. Two minutes, ₹20.
- ☐ Stay on the same screen, search PMJJBY, enrol. Two minutes, ₹436.
- ☐ Check the nominee name on that savings account. Fix it if it is a parent who has passed away or a name you set at 21 and forgot.
- ☐ Go to pmjay.gov.in, click "Am I Eligible", check with your Aadhaar-linked mobile number. Takes a minute.
- ☐ If your parents are 70 or above, apply for the Ayushman Vay Vandana card on the Ayushman app or at a CSC.
- ☐ If you do not pay income tax and you are under 40, ask your bank about APY and pick a slab.
- ☐ Tell whoever runs your house, drives for you or works for you about PMSBY. Most of them have a Jan Dhan account and have never been told.
- ☐ Put a reminder in your calendar for 15 May every year to check that the ₹456 was debited.

4 The words, in plain English

Nominee

The person who receives the money if you die. Not automatically your legal heir, so write the right name.

Neenga illa na, panam yaaruku poganum nu ezhuthi vekkardhu.

Auto-debit

The bank pulls the premium from your account on its own, once a year. If the balance is short, the cover stops.

Bank thaana pudichikkum. Balance illa na cover pogum.

Lien or waiting period

The first 30 days of PMJJBY, when only accidental death is covered.

Modhal 30 naal accident mattum than cover.

Cashless

The hospital bills the government directly. You do not pay first and claim later.

Neenga kaasu kodukka venaam, hospital direct-a claim pannum.

Empanelled hospital

A hospital that has signed up for PM-JAY. The cover only works inside these.

Scheme-la join panna hospital. Adhula mattum than velai seiyum.

SECC 2011

The 2011 socio-economic caste census. The original list PM-JAY eligibility was drawn from.

2011-la eduthaa oru list. Adhula irundhaa PM-JAY kidaikkum.

Total permanent disability

Losing both eyes, both hands or both feet, or one of each. Pays the full ₹2 lakh.

Rendu kai, rendu kaal, rendu kan, edhaavadhu rendu poana full amount.

Corpus

The total pot of money built up in an APY account, returned to the nominee at the end.

Sethukitta mothha thoga. Kadaisila nominee-ku thirumba kidaikkum.

Pro-rata premium

A smaller PMJJBY premium if you join partway through the June to May cover year.

Naduvula join panna, kammi kaasu kattinaa pothum.

Sources, dates and *the fine print*

Every figure in this guide was checked against a government source in September 2026. Schemes change, so check the portal before you act on anything here.

- **PMSBY and PMJJBY premiums, cover, age limits, 30 day lien, pro-rata amounts.** Department of Financial Services, Ministry of Finance, financialservices.gov.in and the revised scheme rules dated 1 June 2022 on jansuraksha.gov.in. Page last updated 5 January 2026.
- **Enrolment and claim figures.** Press Information Bureau release on eleven years of the Jan Suraksha schemes. PMJJBY 27.43 crore enrolments and ₹21,512.50 crore settled on 10,75,625 claims. PMSBY 58.09 crore enrolments and ₹3,667.52 crore settled on 1,84,662 claims. Figures as of 29 April 2026.
- **APY eligibility bar on income tax payers.** Ministry of Finance gazette notification effective 1 October 2022, reported by PIB and carried by Business Standard, Tribune and Moneylife.
- **APY contribution chart and corpus amounts.** Official PFRDA contribution table, unchanged as of September 2026. APY enrolment 9.04 crore as of 30 April 2026.
- **PM-JAY cover, funding pattern and package rules.** National Health Authority, pmjay.gov.in.
- **Ayushman Vay Vandana card for citizens aged 70 and above.** Announced 29 October 2024. PIB release on Vay Vandana cards, which also gives 31,466 empanelled hospitals of which 14,194 are private.
- **Ayushman Sarathi WhatsApp helpline.** PIB release dated 29 June 2026.
- **Section 80CCD(1B).** Income Tax Act. Available only under the old tax regime, which stopped being the default from FY 2023-24.

DISCLAIMER

I am not a SEBI-registered investment adviser and this is not investment or insurance advice. I make finance content and I check my numbers, but I can still be wrong and rules change without much noise. Everything here is general information about government schemes, dated September 2026. Premiums, eligibility rules and cover amounts are revised by the government from time to time. Confirm on the official portals, jansuraksha.gov.in, pmjay.gov.in and enps.nsdl.com, or at your bank branch, before you enrol or rely on any of it. Never pay an agent to enrol you in any of these four schemes. All four are enrolled free, by you, through your own bank or the government portal.

Free to share. Send it to *someone who needs it*.

If one person activates PMSBY because of this, the whole thing was worth writing. Forward it to a parent, a colleague, or whoever helps run your house.

@buildwithabinash